

August 2026

Dear Mike,

I've worked Lamorinda and the surrounding Contra Costa neighborhoods long enough to recognize when a home has genuine substance, and 616 Minert Road caught my attention right away. The combination of a true five-bedroom ranch plan, exposed wood beam ceilings, that Carrara Quartz kitchen, and a pool on a quarter-acre corner lot is not something you see assembled in one place very often at this price range. When the listing came off the market after 49 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because I think the gap between what this home actually offers and what happened during the listing is explainable, and more importantly, fixable.

Forty-nine days is close to the window where buyer psychology begins to shift, and the listing description, while thorough in listing out features, never built a narrative around what makes this home feel different. The beam ceilings, the waterfall island, the pool with solar heating, the mature landscaping with the lemon tree and the rosemary, those details create a lifestyle picture that buyers at \$1,545,000 are shopping for. They needed to experience that picture before they scheduled a showing. A strategy that leads with a feature list and waits for the market to respond is a different strategy than one that actively constructs the story and delivers it to the right buyers.

I've put together a short analysis of what the listing history tells us and how I'd approach a relaunch differently for this specific home. It walks through three specific friction points, where the positioning fell short, and what a campaign built around 616 Minert Road's actual strengths would look like.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside, no hard feelings at all. If you're not, I'd genuinely enjoy a short conversation about what a second run at this could look like done differently.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

616 Minert Rd

Walnut Creek, CA 94598

5.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,211 Sq Ft · Walnut Creek

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 616 Minert Rd

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Ranch Home with Real Architecture and a Resort Backyard - and a Listing That Didn't Show Either

616 Minert Road has the kind of fundamentals that Lamorinda-area buyers at this price point are actively hunting for: five true bedrooms in a single-story ranch plan, exposed wood beam ceilings that create architectural character you can't renovate your way into, a kitchen anchored by a Carrara Quartz waterfall island, and a private backyard with a pool, solar heating, and mature drought-tolerant landscaping on an 11,050-square-foot corner lot. That is a lot of property. The combination of livable square footage, architectural detail, outdoor infrastructure, and lot size is genuinely uncommon in this range.

The listing ran 49 days and came off market without a sale. At \$699 per square foot, this home was priced at the lower end of the Walnut Creek range, which means the value case was actually strong on paper. The problem was not the number. The problem was that the marketing never translated the home's physical character into a buyer experience. Buyers comparing options online need to feel the beam ceilings and the pool setting before they commit to a showing. A listing description that inventories features without constructing that experience leaves buyers with data but not conviction. The strategy ran out of runway before it found the right buyer.

\$1,545,000

List Price

\$699/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this home needs to do one specific thing: close the gap between what 616 Minert Road actually is and what buyers experienced when they found it online. The architecture, the outdoor space, and the lot position are premium story material. They just need a campaign built to tell that story to the buyers who are already looking for it.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 49 Days Without a Narrative Shift

At 49 days on market, 616 Minert Road was approaching the threshold where buyer skepticism becomes self-reinforcing. Past roughly 45 days, the question in a buyer's mind stops being 'Is this a good home?' and becomes 'What is everyone else seeing that I'm missing?' That shift is not a reflection of the home's quality. It's the predictable result of a strategy that held the same position too long without generating new energy or reaching new buyer segments. This home at \$699 per square foot had real value to defend. A proactive pivot, whether that meant repositioned media, a new distribution push, or a short off-market reset to clear the days-on-market clock, could have changed the outcome. Standing still was the only strategy that guaranteed the result we got.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses the Final Offer platform to create transparent, structured offer activity that buyers can see in real time, which generates urgency and restarts momentum without requiring a price adjustment.

Friction #2: A Visual Story That Was Never Told

The beam ceilings, the waterfall island, the pool with copper solar heating, and the quarter-acre corner lot setting are all features that require great photography and immersive media to register with online buyers the way they register in person. Standard MLS angles in flat light turn these assets into checkboxes. A buyer scrolling listings at 10pm from San Francisco needs to feel the ceiling height, understand the pool's relationship to the backyard, and see the lot's corner position before they decide whether 616 Minert Road is worth the drive. If the visual package doesn't deliver that, the most distinctive features in the listing become invisible, and buyers move to the next result. At \$1,545,000, buyers are comparing carefully and making decisions based on what they see before they ever schedule a showing.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour gives buyers aerial context for the lot position, corner setting, and backyard layout that ground photography simply can't replicate, and it's standard on every listing we take.

Friction #3: Distribution Built for a Passive Market

A home listed at \$1,545,000 in 2026 is competing for a buyer pool that has contracted significantly from the 2021 peak, and the buyers who remain at this price point are doing serious research before they commit to anything. They are active online well before they engage with an agent, and they are comparing across multiple markets, including San Francisco and Oakland, before they settle on Walnut Creek. A standard MLS distribution strategy waits for those buyers to find the listing. An active distribution strategy goes out and finds them where they are already looking, specifically in the SF and East Bay zip codes where the relocating buyers for a home like this actually live. The right buyer for 616 Minert Road was almost certainly out there during the listing period. The listing just never appeared in front of them in the right place or the right format.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Contra Costa neighborhoods, putting 616 Minert Road in front of decision-makers before they've found what they're looking for.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	616 Minert Rd	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$699/sqft	Standard updated: \$720–\$800/sqft; Renovated: \$800–\$880/sqft
Lot / Setting	11,050 sqft corner lot with pool, solar heating, mature landscaping	Typical Walnut Creek lot: 6,000–8,500 sqft
Architectural Character	Single-story ranch with exposed wood beam ceilings throughout main living space	Standard two-story or flat-ceiling ranch without distinctive detail
Premium Features	Carrara Quartz waterfall island, brick fireplace with gas insert, built-in hearth seating, 5 bedrooms	3–4 bedroom standard floor plan, builder-grade finishes
HOA	None	None to \$150/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$699/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$720–\$800/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$699 per square foot, 616 Minert Road came in below the standard updated Walnut Creek range of \$720 to \$800, which means the value case on paper was genuinely strong. The lot size, the beam ceilings, the renovated kitchen, and the pool infrastructure all support a price well above where this landed, yet the home didn't sell. That disconnect points directly to a strategy gap, not a pricing problem. The relaunch strategy needs to build the case for what this home actually delivers at this number, because the number itself is not the obstacle.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Building a Visual Campaign Around the Beam Ceilings and the Backyard

The two features that most distinguish 616 Minert Road from comparable inventory are things that photography either captures beautifully or loses entirely: the exposed wood beam ceilings in the main living space and the pool setting on the oversized corner lot. A relaunch campaign starts by getting both of those right. That means cinematic photography, a Sky Tour to show the corner lot position and backyard in aerial context, and a 3D Matterport walkthrough so out-of-area buyers can experience the ceiling height and the floor plan flow before they make the drive. Buyers who see the home properly online show up to showings already sold on it. That changes the dynamic at the offer stage.

Pillar II - Writing the Listing to Sell a Life, Not a Feature List

The original listing description did an honest job of enumerating what's at 616 Minert Road, but a buyer at \$1,545,000 is not buying a feature list. They are buying a vision of daily life: morning coffee by the fireplace with the beam ceiling overhead, weekend afternoons by the pool with the lemon tree in the corner and the rosemary along the fence, dinner parties that flow from the waterfall island to the living room without the kitchen feeling like a separate space. That story was in the house the whole time. It just wasn't in the listing. A relaunch starts with remarks written the way a great buyer's agent describes a home they genuinely love, and the Zillow Showcase placement ensures that narrative reaches the widest possible audience at premium visibility.

Pillar III - Reaching the Buyer Who Hasn't Found Walnut Creek Yet

The most likely buyer for a five-bedroom ranch with a pool on a quarter-acre lot at \$1,545,000 is probably not already shopping Walnut Creek. They may be a family relocating out of San Francisco looking for space and a yard, or an East Bay buyer who has been looking in Orinda or Lafayette and hasn't considered that Walnut Creek delivers comparable lifestyle at a lower per-square-foot cost. Those buyers are active online right now. They just haven't been shown 616 Minert Road yet because the first campaign didn't go looking for them. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns are built specifically to reach that buyer in the neighborhoods where they live today, before they've committed to a market or a street.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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